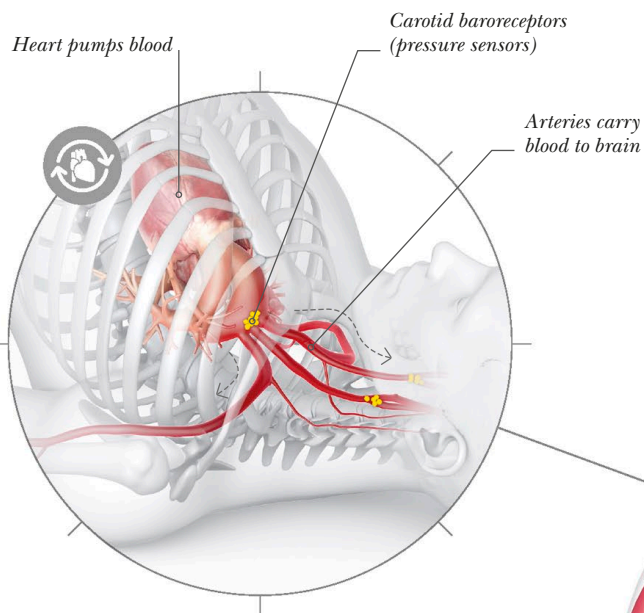
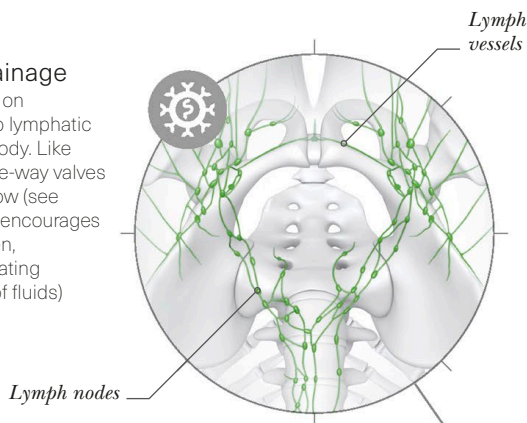


» CLOSER LOOK

Shoulderstand is particularly effective at encouraging lymphatic drainage and improving overall circulation. Although it may not stimulate your thyroid, it can stimulate baroreceptors to lower your blood pressure.

Lymphatic drainage

Lymph vessels rely on movement to pump lymphatic fluid around your body. Like veins, they have one-way valves that prevent backflow (see opposite). Inverting encourages these valves to open, preventing or alleviating edema (a buildup of fluids) in your ankles.



Baroreceptors

When inverting, blood pressure initially goes up. Then, signals to your brain should set in motion a cascade of events to lower your blood pressure and maintain homeostasis. This drop may be enhanced by the physical pressure placed on carotid baroreceptors in neck flexion. Regular practice of inversions could lower your blood pressure over time.

ANTERIOR VIEW

